One wet month does not prove a wetter climate

- Fictional Example Town: 100 mm in September
- Assumed September baseline: 80 mm
- One month cannot establish a long-term change

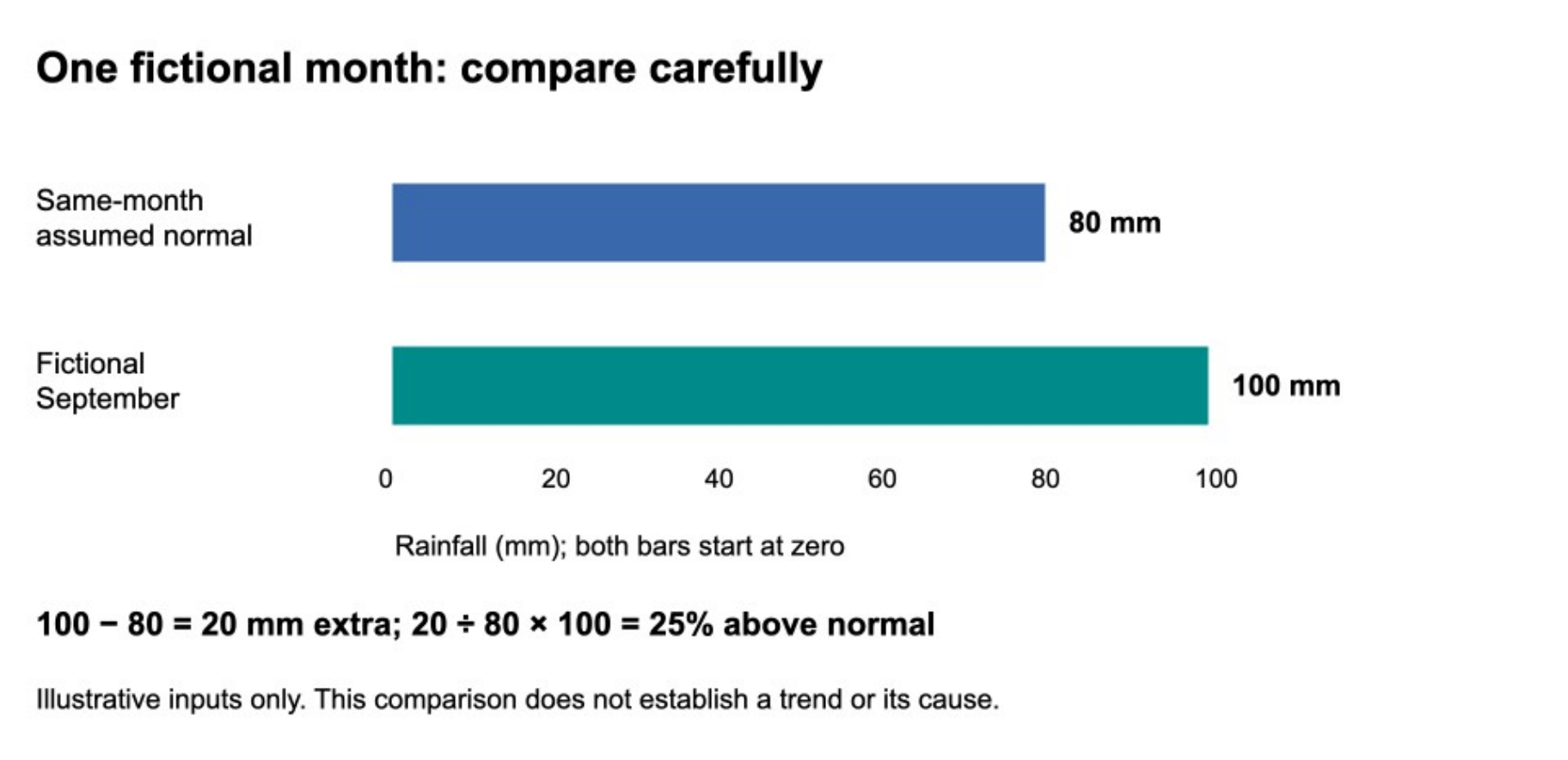
Sources: S1 | Full links and speaking notes in the notes pane

Compare September with September

- Use the same calendar month across years
- Our assumed baseline covers 1991–2020
- Keep examples separate from observations

Sources: S1, S2 | Full links and speaking notes in the notes pane

25 percent above the baseline



Sources: S2 | Full links and speaking notes in the notes pane

Three different questions

- Anomaly: how far from the usual amount?
- Trend: how is rainfall changing over years?
- Attribution: what influenced the event?

Sources: S1, S2, S3, S4 | Full links and speaking notes in the notes pane

What would we need to know?

- Local rainfall records covering many years
- Details of measurement changes and gaps
- How much rainfall varies, and how certain we are

Sources: S1, S2 | Full links and speaking notes in the notes pane

A clear message to share

- Our fictional September is 25 percent above baseline
- One wet month does not establish a wetter climate
- Local conclusions need long-term records and analysis

Sources: S1, S2 | Full links and speaking notes in the notes pane